

```
var me = new Developer();  
me.Build("ERP", modules: 28);  
await me.ChaseDream("game-dev");
```



The complete guide to designing, animating and building the "Sketchbook" portfolio.

Everything in one place: the design system, every section and its content, the full animation script from the loading screen to the footer, how to create the avatar and stickers, responsive rules, the build plan and the launch checklist.

SANDHOSH SIVAN M ♦ .NET BACKEND ♦ FULL STACK ♦ FUTURE GAME DEVELOPER

What's inside

01 The idea and the goal

02 Design system

03 Page structure and content

03B Content written for the web

04 Animation guide: loader to footer

05 Responsive and alignment rules

06 Your assets: audit and pipeline

07 Content you need to provide

08 Technical build plan

09 Phases and timeline

10 Launch checklist

Where this guide came from

- **The problem:** the current site (sandhoshsivanm.github.io/Portfolio) has strong content but reads like a resume: bullet lists and keyword walls. Visitors scan it and leave without knowing who you are.
- **The reference:** a Pinterest "sticker sketchbook" design: a cartoon peeking over a coloured wall, tool stickers with cursors, graph paper, orange highlight boxes with selection handles, script + bold type.
- **The result so far:** mockup v2, approved as the direction. This guide turns it into a finished, premium, fully animated and responsive website.



Mockup v2: the approved direction. The avatar here is a stand-in; the real one is created in Chapter 06.

01 The idea and the goal

A developer's sketchbook: playful on the surface, precise underneath, just like good backend work. Every visitor should leave knowing who Sandhoshsivan M is, what he built, how good he is, and what he dreams of.

The 30-second test

Someone who scrolls the page once, top to bottom, must be able to answer:

QUESTION	WHERE THE PAGE ANSWERS IT
Who is he?	Hero: name, role, avatar; ticker with full name and location
What has he built?	"What I built": one ERP, six modules, live mini-screens
How good is he?	Case notes: 4 real problems with measured results
Who is he as a person?	About (heart side) + Player 2: the game-development dream
How do I reach him?	Contact: copyable email, LinkedIn, GitHub, resume, form

Personality in one line each

Professional

Sole backend engineer of a 28-module ERP serving a 2,000+ employee company. Ledgers, performance, security: the parts most people avoid.

Personal

A game developer at heart. Builds games and engines for the love of it, and dreams of making games for a living.

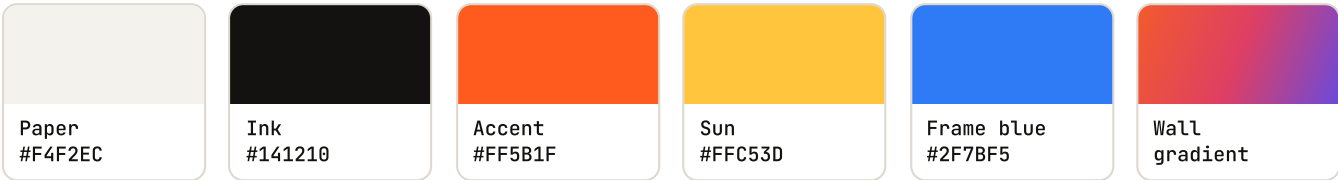
Design principles

1. **Show, don't list.** Every claim becomes an object: a polaroid, a sticky note, an app window, a counter.
2. **One bold place per screen.** The orange selection box is the hero's loud moment; everything around it stays calm.
3. **Premium = consistency.** Same spacing, same radius, same shadow, same timing everywhere.
4. **Playful, never childish.** Real 3D renders and real logos; no emojis, no clip-art.
5. **Fast and accessible.** Animations add delight but never block reading.

02 Design system

The tokens every component uses. Change them here, never inside a component.

Colours



Supporting: ink-2 `#5E5950` (secondary text), ink-3 `#9A948A` (captions), line `rgba(20,18,16,.12)`, success `#1E9E6A`. Sticky-note tints: yellow `#FFE88A`, peach `#FFD2BC`, mint `#CFEBDA`, sky `#D6E2FF`. Arcade section (Player 2): night `#0E0B1F`, neon `#7CF2C8` and `#FF4FD8`.

Typography

ROLE	FONT	USED FOR
Display	Bricolage Grotesque 800	Headings, DEVELOPER., big numbers
Body	Instrument Sans 400–600	Paragraphs, buttons, labels
Handwriting	Caveat 500–700	Letter, side notes, captions
Signature	Mr Dafoe	"Sandhosh", "together!!", accent words in headings
Code	JetBrains Mono 500–600	Eyebrows, chips, chalk code, loader terminal
Pixel (Player 2 only)	Press Start 2P / Silkscreen	Arcade headline and quest log

Type scale (fluid with `clamp()`): hero 52→124 px · H2 34→58 px · H3 20–24 px · body 16 px · small 13–14 px · eyebrow 12 px mono, letter-spacing .14em.

Shape, depth and space

TOKEN	VALUE
Spacing	4-point scale: 4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 24 · 32 · 48 · 64 · 96 · 120 px (section gap 120 desktop / 80 mobile)
Radius	pill 999 · card 20 · window 18 · sticker 20 · polaroid 4 · wall 26
Soft shadow	<code>0 1px 0 rgba(0,0,0,.04)</code> , <code>0 18px 40px -18px rgba(30,20,10,.28)</code>
Sticker shadow	<code>0 1px 1px rgba(0,0,0,.08)</code> , <code>0 10px 22px -8px rgba(40,20,10,.38)</code>
Hard shadow	<code>8px 8px 0 #141210</code> , project windows only
Container	max 1200 px, side padding 16 / 24 / 32 px

Signature components

Sticker

Real logo or 3D render on a 6 px white die-cut border, gloss sheen, sticker shadow, tilt $\pm 8^\circ$, floats, draggable.

Selection frame

Figma-style blue outline, four white handles, optional size label. Used on DEVELOPER., LET'S BUILD and as the focus ring.

Named cursor

Coloured arrow + name pill ("Recruiter", "Tech lead", "You"). Drifts slowly; hidden on phones.

Tape

Semi-transparent yellow strip with torn edges (CSS clip-path). Holds letters, polaroids and notes.

Polaroid

White frame, mini-UI "screenshot", title, one-line description. Straight grid; only the inner layer tilts.

App window

Title bar with traffic lights + hard shadow. For side projects.

03 Page structure and content

One page with nine sections in a deliberate order: identity → person → dream → proof → craft → story → skills → contact.

Structure and facts only. This chapter lists what each section contains and the facts it draws on. The final on-page wording is in **Chapter 03B**, rewritten for the web.

1 • Hero

- "WELCOME TO MY" → lit brick wall with chalk code: `var me = new Developer(); / SELECT * FROM Ideas WHERE Coffee > 0;`
- Stickers: C#, .NET, SQL Server, Redis, Docker, Azure (real logos). Named cursors: Recruiter, Tech lead.
- Your **3D avatar peeking over the wall** (pose A1), eyes following the mouse.
- "Sandhosh" signature over the orange **DEVELOPER**. selection frame; size label ".NET · Full stack"; a "You" cursor pointing at it.
- Ticker band: *Sandhoshsivan M ♦ .NET Backend ♦ Full Stack ♦ Coimbatore, India ♦ Future game developer ♦ Open to new roles*
- Buttons: See my work · Download resume · Say hello

2 • About me (two halves)

Work side

Taped handwritten letter: *"I'm a .NET backend developer from Coimbatore. Since March 2024 I've been the only backend engineer on a 28-module ERP that runs HR, procurement, finance, facilities and safety for a company of 2,000+ people."*

Stat cards (2×2): ~600 REST endpoints · 28 ERP modules · 2,000+ employees · 500+ concurrent users. Caption: for Adeeb Group, Abu Dhabi.

Heart side (new)

Polaroid of your 3D portrait + a short personal note in your words: who you are outside work, why you love building things, and that **your dream is to become a game developer**.

3D stickers around it: gamepad, star, rocket. Hobby chips (2–3 real ones from you).

3 • Player 2: the game-dev dream (new)

The emotional peak of the page. The paper "powers off" into a dark arcade panel.

- Headline (pixel font): **"By day I build ERPs. By night I build worlds."**
- Sun of Elegance gameplay loop inside a hand-drawn TV/console frame.
- What you built: a 2D platformer in C# / .NET 9 on MonoGame, hand-written swept-AABB physics, player state machine, procedural audio, 42 unit tests, CI on 3 operating systems.
- **Quest log** (your real goals): ☒ Ship my first 2D platformer · ☐ Learn a 3D engine (Unity / Godot / Unreal) · ☐ Release a game on itch.io or Steam · ☐ Join a game studio.
- Your avatar holding a controller (pose A2). Button: "Play / watch the game" (repo or itch.io link).

4 • What I built: one ERP, six worlds

POLAROID	MINI - SCREEN	LINE
HR & Payroll	Attendance calendar, 96%	Attendance, leave, wages and approvals for 2,000+ staff
Procurement	RFQ → PO → GRN → INV	Request to invoice, with budget and approval checks
Finance & GL	Dr/Cr table, "Balanced ✓"	Double-entry ledger with 16 posting handlers
Facilities	Work order + progress bar	Assets, planned maintenance and work orders
Safety (HSE)	Permit checklist	Incidents, permits and compliance tracking
Smart documents	Document + OCR scan line	Azure OCR reads 9 document types, saving 20 h a month

5 • Case notes: hard problems, solved

RESULT	PROBLEM	FIX
0 double-posts	Cross-module events could post the same journal twice	RabbitMQ, idempotent consumers, dead-letter queues; ledger passed internal audit
104 GB → <100 ms	Unindexed 104 GB log table pinned production CPU	Traced it, targeted indexes
-30% P95	Hot reads hit SQL Server every request	Two-tier cache: FusionCache + Redis
20 h/month saved	Manual typing from paper documents	Azure Document Intelligence OCR, 9 document types

6 • After hours

Khazana: offline-first finance

Zero telemetry, local double-entry ledger (23 tables), AES-256 + PBKDF2 at 600,000 iterations (49 ms unlock), FIFO lots and XIRR, 1,504 automated tests. TypeScript · Web Crypto · SQLite FTS5 · CI/CD.

HireFlow Pro v2: AI job tracker

Resume scoring 0–100 with Claude and Gemini, hash cache + plan quotas, 6-stage Kanban with audit trail, Stripe billing, Docker on Render. .NET 10 · React 19 · PostgreSQL.

7 • Journey • 8 • Toolbox • 9 • Contact

- Journey:** Aug 2019 B.E. CSE, Rathinam → 2023 graduated + AZ-900 → Mar 2024 Technoduces (sole backend on the ERP) → 2025 Khazana + HireFlow → Now: open to new roles → *Next: game developer* (glowing ghost stop).
- Toolbox:** Backend (C#, .NET 9/10, ASP.NET Core, EF Core, Dapper, SignalR) · Data (SQL Server, PostgreSQL, Redis, RabbitMQ) · Frontend (TypeScript, React, Angular) · Cloud & Ops (Azure, Docker, CI/CD, OpenTelemetry) · Game dev (MonoGame, C#; next: Unity/Godot). Certificates: AZ-900 (2023), Claude Code in Action (2026), Redis University (2026).
- Contact:** "LET'S BUILD together!!", waving avatar (A4), copyable email sandhoshsivan00@gmail.com, LinkedIn, GitHub, resume, contact form.

03B Content: written for the web, not copied from the resume

A resume is a list of evidence for a screener. A portfolio is a story for a person. If the site repeats the resume word for word, there is no reason to visit it. Every line below is rewritten to be read in seconds, understood without jargon, and remembered.

Resume vs portfolio

	RESUME	PORTFOLIO
Reader	Screener with a checklist, 6 seconds	Recruiter, tech lead or founder who chose to visit
Voice	Third person, noun-heavy	First person, conversational
Leads with	Technology and duties	The outcome for real people
Density	Every keyword, every bullet	One idea per block; detail on demand
Proof	Claims	Stories, numbers, visuals and things you can click

The six copy rules

1. **Outcome first, technology second.** "Every screen got ~30% faster", not "Implemented FusionCache + Redis".
2. **Three layers: skim → read → dig.** A headline anyone understands, one human sentence, then an expandable *Under the hood* with the exact stack for engineers.
3. **Talk like a person.** "I", short sentences, no "responsible for", "leveraged" or "utilised".
4. **One number per card.** The biggest one, made big. Other numbers go into the detail layer.
5. **Translate for two audiences.** Recruiters get impact, engineers get specifics. Both are on the same card, in different layers.
6. **Never invent.** Every line traces back to a real fact. Personal-story drafts stay marked until Sandhosh rewrites them in his own words.

Before and after

RESUME (BEFORE)	PORTFOLIO (AFTER)
Sole backend engineer for a 28-module ERP, ~600 endpoints, 2,000+ employee client	I built the backend a 2,000-person company runs on, by myself.
Reduced P95 latency ~30% with FusionCache + Redis two-tier caching	Every screen, about 30% faster. The same data was being fetched again and again, so I taught the system to remember it.
Resolved CPU spike from 104 GB unindexed log table; sub-100 ms queries	From a 104 GB slowdown to under 100 ms. The server kept choking; I found the culprit and fixed it.
Azure Document Intelligence OCR across 9 document types, saving 20 h/month	Paper in, data out. Nobody retypes documents any more: 20 hours back every month.

Section copy (final drafts)

1 • Hero

ELEMENT	COPY
Script + box	Sandhosh / DEVELOPER.
Headline	I build the backend a 2,000-person company runs on.
Sub-line	.NET developer by day. Game maker by night.
Ticker	Sandhoshsivan M ♦ Backend & full stack ♦ Coimbatore, India ♦ Open to new roles ♦ Future game developer
Buttons	See what I built · Get my resume · Say hello
Named cursors	"Recruiter", "Tech lead", "You"

2 • About: work side (the taped letter)

Every day, 2,000 people at a company in Abu Dhabi clock in, raise purchase orders, approve invoices and get paid, on software I built.

Since March 2024 I've been the only backend engineer behind it: 28 modules, one codebase, no hand-offs.

I'm happiest in the parts people avoid: money that has to balance to the cent, queries that crawl, and permissions that can't leak a single row.

Stat cards (one number, one plain label):

NUMBER	LABEL	UNDER THE HOOD
2,000+	people use it at work	Adeeb Group, Abu Dhabi
28	modules, one codebase	HR, payroll, procurement, finance, facilities, safety...
~600	APIs behind every screen	ASP.NET Core, EF Core, SQL Server
500+	online at the same time	Peak concurrent users

2 • About: heart side (DRAFT, needs Sandhosh's own words)

Before I built my first API, I wanted to make games. I still do. At night I build them from scratch in C#: my own physics, my own sound, my own bugs. One day I want to make games for a living.

The rest of my free time goes to money: how it grows, how to invest it, how to keep it. I study personal finance and investing for myself, and that curiosity is exactly why I built Khazana.

Replace with the true story: the first game that hooked you, and what got you into investing.

2 • About: "Things I'm into" (three hobby cards)

CARD	HEADLINE	ONE LINE	STICKER
------	----------	----------	---------

Games	Making games	I build small games from scratch, just for the joy of it	gamepad
Finance	Money that grows	I study personal finance and investing, and I use what I learn	rising chart / coin stack
Third hobby	(from Sandhosh)	(his words)	(matching sticker)

One thread runs through the whole site: money. At work he builds ledgers that must balance to the cent. In his free time he studies investing. After hours he built Khazana, a finance app. The copy links these on purpose: the Finance card in "What I built" and the Khazana card each carry a small note, "Finance is also my hobby", that points back to About.

3 • Player 2: the dream

ELEMENT	COPY
Headline (pixel font)	By day I build ERPs. By night I build worlds.
Game card	Sun of Elegance: a 2D platformer I built from scratch. No engine shortcuts: I wrote the physics, the controls and the sound myself.
Under the hood	C# / .NET 9 · MonoGame · swept-AABB collision · player state machine · procedural audio · 42 unit tests · CI on Windows, macOS, Linux
Quest log	✓ Ship my first game · ☐ Learn a 3D engine · ☐ Release on itch.io or Steam · ☐ Join a game studio
Button	Watch it play · See the code

4 • What I built: "One ERP, six worlds"

CARD TITLE	ONE LINE	UNDER THE HOOD
Payday, on time	Attendance, leave and salaries for 2,000+ people, worked out automatically	HR & payroll module
From request to invoice	Buying goes from "I need this" to "paid" without a lost email	RFQ → PO → GRN → invoice, budget checks
Books that always balance	Every transaction posts to the ledger by itself, correctly	Double-entry GL, 16 posting handlers
Buildings that don't break	Maintenance happens before things fail	Assets, planned maintenance, work orders
Safe sites	Permits, inspections and incidents in one place	HSE module
Paper in, data out	Scanned documents fill themselves in: 20 hours saved a month	Azure Document Intelligence, 9 document types

5 • Case notes: "Hard problems, solved"

Each note uses the same shape: **big result** → *what went wrong* → *what I did* → *under the hood*.

RESULT	STORY (2 LINES)	UNDER THE HOOD
Zero double-counted money	When modules talk, a retry could book the same payment twice. I made every message safe to repeat, and the ledger passed internal audit.	RabbitMQ, idempotent consumers, dead-letter queues
104 GB → under 100 ms	The server kept choking. I traced it to a giant log table no one had indexed, fixed it, and the spikes stopped.	SQL Server execution plans, targeted indexes
Every screen ~30% faster	The same data was fetched again and again. Now the system remembers it, for all 500+ users.	FusionCache (memory) + Redis, P95 latency
Nobody retypes paper	Staff copied scanned documents by hand. Now the system reads them.	Azure Document Intelligence OCR

6 • After hours: "Things I build for fun"

Khazana

A money app that keeps your data yours.

Built because personal finance is my hobby, and I wanted a tool I could trust.

- Works fully offline; nothing leaves your device
- Bank-grade encryption, unlocks in 49 ms
- Shows your real investment returns
- 1,504 automated tests before every release

Under the hood: TypeScript · AES-256 · PBKDF2 600k · SQLite FTS5 · FIFO lots · XIRR

HireFlow Pro

Know your resume score before you apply.

- AI scores your resume against a job, 0–100
- Shows the keywords you're missing
- Tracks every application on one board
- Built to keep AI costs low

Under the hood: .NET 10 · React 19 · PostgreSQL · Claude + Gemini · Stripe · Docker

7 • Journey: "How I got here"

WHEN	HEADLINE	ONE LINE
2019	Started engineering	B.E. Computer Science, Rathinam
2023	Graduated	And earned my Azure certification
Mar 2024	Joined Technoduces	Became the only backend engineer on a live ERP
2025	Started shipping my own products	Khazana and HireFlow Pro
Now	Looking for my next team	Backend or full stack
Next	Making games for a living	The dream

8 • Toolbox: grouped by what the tools are for

GROUP TITLE	TOOLS
Building APIs	C#, .NET 9/10, ASP.NET Core, EF Core, Dapper, SignalR
Storing and moving data	SQL Server, PostgreSQL, Redis, RabbitMQ
Building screens	TypeScript, React, Angular
Shipping it	Azure, Docker, CI/CD, OpenTelemetry
Making games	MonoGame, C#; next: a 3D engine
My AI pair-programmers	Claude, Cursor, Copilot

9 • Contact

ELEMENT	COPY
Headline	LET'S BUILD together!!
Line	Got a hard backend problem, or a game idea? I'd love to hear it.

Helper	Email is the fastest way to reach me.
--------	---------------------------------------

Copy toast	Copied! Talk soon.
------------	--------------------

Extras

- **"In a hurry?" card** (recruiter mode): 4 lines covering role, years, top achievement and availability, plus a resume button.
- **Page title / SEO:** "Sandhoshsivan M · .NET Backend Developer". Meta: "I build the backend a 2,000-person company runs on, and games at night."
- **404 page:** "This level doesn't exist yet. Back to the start?"

04 Animation guide: loader to footer

The full motion script, in the order a visitor experiences it. One choreographed moment per section; everything else is quiet.

4.0 Motion tokens and rules

TOKEN	VALUE	USED FOR
fast	150 ms	Hover, press
base	300 ms	Cards, chips, fades
slow	600 ms	Section entrances, line drawing
story	1200 ms	Hero sequence, signatures
ease-out	cubic-bezier(.22, 1, .36, 1)	Almost everything
spring-pop	stiffness 260, damping 18	Stickers, handles, dots
stagger	70–90 ms	Lists of cards, chips, stickers

Rules. Animate only transform, opacity and SVG stroke. Every element has a visible resting state, so the page reads even if JavaScript fails. Entrances play once. With *prefers-reduced-motion*: no loader, no float or drift, everything shown static, video paused with a Play button. Libraries: framer-motion (installed), lenis (smooth scroll), canvas-confetti (3 KB).

4.1 Loading screen: "the build log" (≈1.6 s, first visit only)

```
> dotnet build Sandhoshsivan.Portfolio
Restoring coffee...           done
Compiling 28 modules...       done
Loading dreams: game-dev.dll  done
Build succeeded. 0 warnings, 0 errors ✓
```

TIME	WHAT HAPPENS
0 ms	Blank graph paper; a small dark terminal card fades in at the centre
100–900 ms	Build lines type in, one every ~150 ms; last line turns green. A thin orange bar tracks real loading (avatar image + fonts)
900–1400 ms	A 3D clay pencil sweeps across and signs "Sandhosh" under the terminal (SVG stroke reveal)
1400–1700 ms	Masking tape at the top peels; the loader card slides up and off like a torn sheet, and the hero begins

Shown once per session (`sessionStorage`); repeat visits go straight to the hero. Any key or tap skips it. Hard cap 2.5 s even on slow networks.

4.2 Hero entrance (≈1.8 s)

TIME	WHAT HAPPENS
0-400 ms	"WELCOME TO MY" letters drop in one by one (y -12 → 0, stagger 30 ms)
200-600 ms	Wall unfolds (scaleY .85 → 1 from the bottom); the gradient brightens like lights switching on
400-1200 ms	Chalk code types itself on both sides, with a blinking caret
500-1100 ms	Avatar rises from behind the ledge (y 40% → 0, spring)
950-1150 ms	Hands slap onto the ledge, left then right, 80 ms apart, with a tiny squash
700-1300 ms	Stickers slap on: scale 1.35 → 1, rotation overshoot, shadow pulse (stagger 90 ms)
1300 ms	Avatar blinks (eyes-closed frame, 120 ms)
900-1700 ms	"Sandhosh" signature draws itself
1000-1600 ms	Selection frame draws around DEVELOPER. from the top-left corner → handles pop → orange fill wipes left to right → text slides up inside
1500-1800 ms	Size label pops; named cursors fly in from off-screen and settle
1700 ms →	Ticker starts scrolling; buttons fade up

Idle life after the intro

- Eyes follow the mouse (desktop) or the last touch (mobile); random blink every 4–7 s.
- Stickers float gently and are **draggable**, springing back when released.
- Named cursors drift; hovering one shows a tooltip ("Recruiter is reading your CV...").
- On desktop, a small orange "You" label follows the real cursor.

4.3 Navigation and scroll

- **Floating pill nav** appears after the hero (About · Dream · Work · Notes · Contact). A hand-drawn squiggle slides under the active item. On phones it sits at the bottom.
- **Scroll progress** is a pencil line drawing across the top edge.
- Smooth scrolling with Lenis; anchor links glide.

4.4 Section by section

SECTION	ENTRANCE	INTERACTION / IDLE
About	Letter slides in and the tape "sticks" (scale .6 → 1); a marker sweeps under "only backend engineer"; portrait polaroid drops in	Stats count up from 0; squiggle underlines draw
Player 2	CRT turn-on: a white line expands to fill the panel, scanlines fade in, headline types in pixel font	Gameplay plays only while visible; quest items tick one by one; a pixel character runs along the bottom with scroll; Konami code (↑↑↓↓←→←→BA) or 5 taps on the controller → 8-bit confetti + "Player 2 has joined"

What I built	Polaroids drop and pin (stagger 80 ms); tape lands last	Mini-screens come alive: calendar fills, process arrows run, ledger ticks "Balanced", progress bar fills, checklist ticks, OCR line sweeps. Hover lifts the card
Case notes	Sticky notes peel down from the top (rotateX $-18^\circ \rightarrow 0$)	Metrics animate: "104 GB" counts down to "<100 ms", "-30%" counts
After hours	Windows open from the title bar (scale .96 $\rightarrow$ 1); traffic lights pop	Gentle 3D tilt following the mouse ($\pm 4^\circ$); chips pop
Journey	Dashed path draws as you scroll	Dots pop as the line reaches them; "Now" pulses; "Next: game developer" glows
Toolbox	Bins slide up; logos slap on like stickers	Logo wiggles on hover
Contact	Mirrors the hero: frame draws around "LET'S BUILD", "together!!" signs itself, avatar waves	Copy email $\rightarrow$ "Copied ✓" + mini-sticker confetti; form submit $\rightarrow$ paper plane flies off

4.5 Micro-interactions

- Buttons: hover lifts 2 px; press moves down 1 px and the shadow shrinks.
- Links: a hand-drawn underline draws in on hover.
- Keyboard focus: the blue selection frame with corner handles (on brand and accessible).
- Images fade in from a blurred low-res placeholder.

4.6 Animations mapped to your assets

MOMENT	YOUR ASSETS	ANIMATION
Loader	pencil, sparkle, paper card	Terminal types the build; sparkle pops on "Build succeeded ✓"; pencil writes "Sandhosh"; the card flies up to reveal the hero
Hero peek	chibi boy + hand $\times 2$	Boy rises behind the wall; hands slap onto the ledge (left, then right, tiny squash); eyes follow the pointer; blink every 4–7 s
Hero stickers	C#, .NET, SQL, Redis, Docker, Azure (+ React, TS, RabbitMQ)	Slap on (scale 1.3 $\rightarrow$ 1, stagger); float; draggable with spring-back; peel-lift on hover
Cursors	cursor, click-cursor	Fly in as "Recruiter" and "Tech lead"; click-cursor bursts on the DEVELOPER. box
DEVELOPER. box	blue circle, sparkle	Frame draws, orange fill wipes, the blue circle scribbles around it, sparkle twinkles
Section headings	torn papers (orange, purple, black, grids)	Paper tears in (clip-path reveal) and settles with a 2° rotate
About	card, bulb, squiggle	Card drops with tape; bulb lights up on "I like the hard parts"; squiggle draws under the counting numbers
Case notes	arrows, star, database, API + server	Arrows draw from problem to fix; database shakes then calms beside "104 GB $\rightarrow$ <100 ms"; star stamps each result

Toolbox	< >, stickers, AI-tools row	Brackets open to reveal the bins; stickers slap on; new "AI-assisted development" row (Claude · Cursor · Copilot)
Journey	arrows, star	Path draws with scroll; arrow points to "Next: game developer"; star burst
Contact	LinkedIn, GitHub, Claude, sparkle, stickers	Icons wiggle on hover; copy email → confetti made of your own stickers

05 Responsive and alignment rules

It must look designed on a 360 px phone, an iPad in either orientation, a laptop and an ultra-wide monitor.

Breakpoints

NAME	WIDTH	TYPICAL DEVICE
xs	360–479 px	Small phones
sm	480–767 px	Large phones
md	768–1023 px	Tablet portrait
lg	1024–1279 px	Tablet landscape, small laptop
xl	1280–1535 px	Laptop, desktop
2xl	1536 px +	Large and ultra-wide (content capped at 1200 px)

Layout per section

SECTION	PHONE	TABLET	DESKTOP
Hero	Wall → avatar → name; 2 stickers in corners; no chalk or cursors	4 stickers, left chalk only	Full scene
About	1 column	Letter, then stats 2×2	2 columns
Player 2	Stacked	Video above text	Video text
ERP polaroids	1 column	2 columns	3 columns
Case notes	1 column	2 columns	2 columns
Projects	1 column	1 column	2 columns
Journey	Vertical	Vertical	Horizontal path
Toolbox	1 column	2 columns	4 columns

Fixing the misaligned columns

Cause in mockup v2: whole cards were rotated (−1.6°, +1.2° ...). A rotated box sticks out of its grid cell, so neighbouring edges no longer line up, which reads as "misaligned".

- 1. **Grid cells never rotate.** The card sits straight; only an inner decorative layer (paper, tape) tilts, at most ±1°.
- 2. **Equal heights per row:** `grid-auto-rows: 1fr` + flex column inside, so tops and bottoms align.
- 3. **One container** for every section, so every heading starts on the same left edge.

4. **Same inner padding and baselines** in sibling cards (numbers, labels and chips line up across cards).
5. **Fluid type** with `clamp()` ; script overlaps positioned in `em` so they scale with the heading.
6. **Aspect-ratio safety**: wall height `clamp(220px, 28vw, 320px)` , avatar sized by width; tested at 16:9, 16:10, 4:3, 21:9 and 9:19.5.



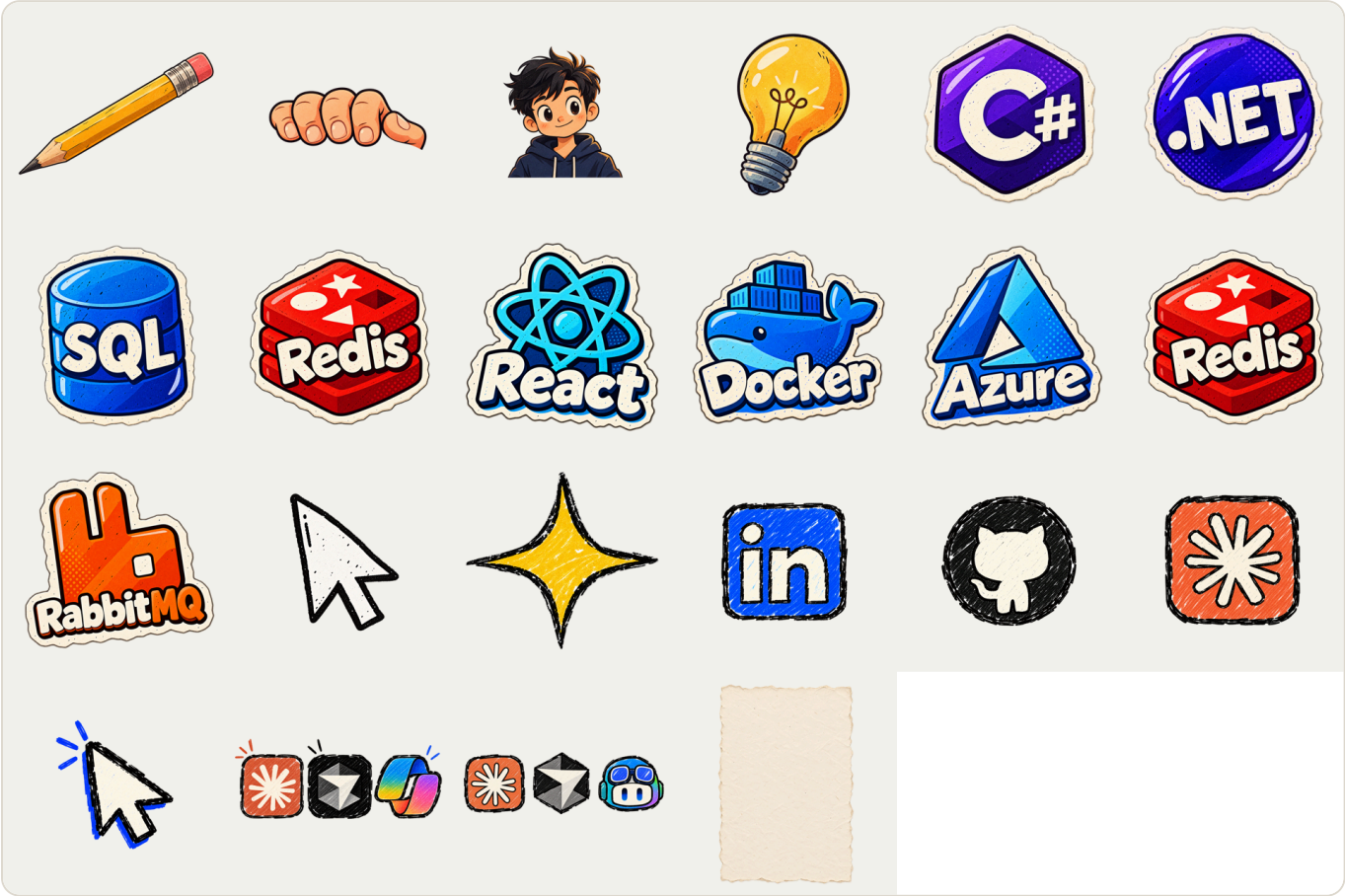
Phone view of mockup v2.

Already stacks to one column. Still to fix in the build: hide the "Frame · Role" label on small screens, keep cursors away from the face, enlarge tap targets to at least 44 px, and keep the ticker readable at 13 px.

06 Your assets: audit and pipeline

You created 41 hand-drawn sticker assets in one consistent crayon-and-die-cut style. That consistency is what makes the site look premium. This chapter checks every file and explains how each one gets ready for the web.

6.1 Ready to use: 22 files with real transparency



Shown on the site's paper colour: clean edges, no halos.

GROUP	ASSETS	ROLE ON THE SITE
Tech stickers	C#, .NET, SQL, Redis (×2, one spare), React, Docker, Azure, RabbitMQ	Hero stickers, toolbox, confetti
Avatar	Chibi boy (bust) + gripping hand	Hero peek: boy behind the wall + two hands (one mirrored) on the ledge
Doodles	Pencil, light bulb, yellow sparkle, cursor, click-cursor	Loader, About, DEVELOPER. box, named cursors
Icons	LinkedIn, GitHub, Claude, AI-tools rows (Claude · Cursor · Copilot)	Contact, new "AI-assisted development" row
Paper	Blank card, paper texture	Letter card, loader card, page texture

Avatar style decision. The chibi boy matches the sticker style better than the older 3D Pixar render, so the site uses the chibi boy. The peek is made by layering the boy and the hand, so no new render is needed.

6.2 Needs cleaning: 18 files



The grey checkerboard is painted into these images; they have no real transparency.

PROBLEM	FILES	FIX
Painted checkerboard	Torn papers (blue grid, yellow grid, orange, purple, black), blue circle, star, two arrows, squiggle, <>, database, API + server, .NET + cursor, .NET (alt)	Automatic clean-up script
Solid background	TypeScript (black), torn gradient strip (white)	Same script, keyed on black or white
Combined sheet	10-logo sheet on dark background	Reference only; cannot animate per logo

6.3 Clean-up pipeline (automatic, Phase 0)

- 1. Flood-fill from the image borders, treating the two checker greys, black or white ($\pm$ tolerance) as background.
- 2. Feather the edge by 1 px and remove colour fringing.
- 3. Trim to the content with 4% padding.
- 4. Export **WebP q90 at 1024 px** plus a **400 px** phone version; keep the originals in `references/assets-raw/`.
- 5. QA contact sheet on light paper and on the dark arcade colour, which you approve.

6.4 Folder and naming

```
public/assets/  
  stickers/  csharp dotnet sql redis react docker azure rabbitmq typescript  
  avatar/    boy hand boy-blink* boy-controller* boy-wave*  
  doodles/   pencil bulb sparkle star circle arrow-curve arrow-up squiggle  
             code-brackets database api-server  
  paper/     torn-blue-grid torn-yellow-grid torn-orange torn-purple  
             torn-black torn-strip card texture  
  icons/     linkedin github claude ai-tools  
  game/      dream.webm dream.mp4 dream-poster.webp*      (* = still to create)
```

6.5 Still to create (same AI chat, same style)

PRIORITY	ASSET	WHY	FALLBACK IF MISSING
P1	boy-blink: same boy, eyes closed	Hero idle blink	CSS eyelid overlay
P1	boy-controller: holding a gamepad, excited	Player 2 section	Boy bust + gamepad sticker in front
P1	Game-dev stickers: gamepad, MonoGame, pixel heart, coin	Player 2 has no matching art yet	Generic 3D clay icons
P1	Finance stickers: rising chart, coin stack, piggy bank	"Money that grows" hobby card, Khazana card	3D clay chart icon (already in repo)
P2	boy-wave	Contact section	Boy bust + sparkle
P2	Angular, Git, PostgreSQL stickers	Toolbox completeness	Chips without stickers
P2	Masking tape strip; sticky notes (yellow, peach, mint)	More realistic notes	CSS tape and notes
P3	Sun of Elegance gameplay clip (10–15 s)	Player 2 video	Poster image + GitHub link

Prompt suffix for every new asset

Same hand-drawn sticker style as before, cream die-cut border, crayon texture, isolated on a PURE WHITE background (not a checkerboard), 1500 px.

Why white? AI tools often "fake" transparency with a painted checkerboard. A plain white background is removed cleanly and reliably by the script.

Gameplay clip commands

```
ffmpeg -i raw.mp4 -t 12 -an -vf scale=960:-2 -c:v libvpx-vp9 -b:v 0 -crf 34 dream.webm
ffmpeg -i raw.mp4 -t 12 -an -vf scale=960:-2 -c:v libx264 -crf 26 -movflags +faststart dream.mp4
ffmpeg -i raw.mp4 -ss 3 -frames:v 1 dream-poster.webp
```

07 Content you need to provide

The site can start with A1 alone, but these make it personal and complete.

- ☐ **Done ✓** 41 sticker assets (tech stickers, avatar, hand, doodles, papers, icons)
- ☐ **P1 assets:** boy-blink, boy-controller, game-dev stickers (gamepad, MonoGame, pixel heart, coin)
- ☐ **Your game-dev story**, 5–8 lines: why games; the first game that made you want to build games; favourite games and studios; which engine you want next; your dream role
- ☐ **Quest log goals:** confirm or edit the four in Chapter 03
- ☐ **Sun of Elegance:** a 10–15 s clip and a public repo or itch.io link
- ☐ **Hobbies:** ✓ game development ✓ personal finance and investing (what got you into it? any one-line takeaway?) · optional third hobby
- ☐ **Links** for Khazana and HireFlow Pro, if public

Data to confirm (resume vs current repo)

ITEM	RESUME (OCT 2026)	REPO PROFILE.TS	DEFAULT
Full name	Sandhoshsivan M	Sandhoshsivan M	Sandhoshsivan M ✓ (confirmed)
Phone	+91 86108 28200	+91 86208 28200	Resume
GitHub	github.com/sandhoshsivanM	github.com/sandhoshsivan	Resume
Endpoints	~600	975+ controllers ("don't use 600+")	Resume
Location	Coimbatore	Abu Dhabi → Bangalore · Chennai · Remote	Resume

08 Technical build plan

Rebuild inside the existing project `~/resume/sandhosh-portfolio` : Next.js 16 (App Router), React 19, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS 4, framer-motion, nodemailer.

File map

```
src/
  content/
    profile.ts      all copy lives here; components hold no strings
                    name, pitch, contact, metrics      (update from resume)
    experience.ts   role, journey stops, ERP modules   (update)
    projects.ts     Khazana, HireFlow Pro v2           (update)
    caseStudies.ts  4 case notes                       (update)
    skills.ts       5 toolbox bins + certificates      (update)
    interests.ts    real hobbies                       (replace placeholders)
    dream.ts        Player 2 story, quest log, game     (NEW)
  components/ui/    Sticker, SelectionFrame, NamedCursor, Tape, Polaroid,
                    StickyNote, AppWindow, Chip, Doodle, Counter,
                    DrawPath, TypeLines                (+ existing Reveal, Section)
  components/site/  Loader (NEW), Hero, About, GameDream (NEW),
                    ErpModules (NEW), CaseNotes, Projects, Journey,
                    Toolbox, Contact, Nav, Footer
  lib/motion.ts     timing tokens, easings, shared variants
  hooks/            useEyeFollow, useReducedMotion, useInView, useKonami
  public/assets/
    character/ 3d/ tech/ game/
```

Libraries

PACKAGE	WHY	SIZE
framer-motion	All sequences, springs, drag, scroll-linked paths (installed)	~ already in
lenis	Smooth scrolling	~3 KB
canvas-confetti	Copy-email and Konami celebrations	~3 KB
next/font	Self-host the 5 Google fonts (no layout shift)	built in

Performance budget

- First load JS ≤ 180 KB gzipped; LCP (avatar) ≤ 2.0 s on 4G; CLS ≈ 0.
- Avatar preloaded; every other image lazy, WebP/AVIF through `next/image` .
- Video loads only when Player 2 approaches the viewport; poster first.

Hosting

OPTION	PROS	CONS
Vercel (recommended)	Free; keeps the nodemailer contact API; preview links per commit	New URL (or a custom domain)

GitHub Pages

Keeps sandhoshsivanm.github.io/Portfolio

Static only: switch the form to Formspree; needs

```
output: 'export' + basePath:  
'/Portfolio'
```

09 Phases and timeline

PHASE	WORK	OUTPUT	GATE
0 • Assets	Clean 18 files, rename, export WebP (1024 + 400 px), QA contact sheet	public/assets/**	✓ You approve the cleaned sheet
1 • Content	Update content files from the resume + your story	src/content/**	✓ You approve the copy
2 • Foundation	Tokens, fonts, container, motion tokens, UI components	/dev component page	n/a
3 • Loader + Hero	Full motion with your real avatar and stickers	Live preview	✓ You see real animation
4 • Sections	About → Player 2 → What I built → Case notes → After hours → Journey → Toolbox → Contact	Full page	✓ Your review
5 • Responsive	Alignment pass, screenshots at 8+ widths	Screenshot set	n/a
6 • Polish	Timing, performance, SEO/OG image, accessibility	Lighthouse report	✓ Your review
7 • Launch	Deploy, replace the old site, update LinkedIn and resume links	Live URL	✓ Your OK

Estimate: about **6–8 working days** after the P1 assets and your story arrive. Phase 0 can start right away.

Next step. Say "start" to run Phase 0 (asset clean-up only; no other project files change). In parallel, create the P1 assets and write your game-dev story.

10 Launch checklist

Visual and responsive

- ☐ Screenshots at 360, 390, 768, 820, 1024, 1280, 1440 and 1920 px, plus iPad landscape and 21:9: no horizontal scroll, no overlaps
- ☐ Card edges line up in every row; headings share one left edge
- ☐ Real avatar, real logos, no placeholder text anywhere

Motion

- ☐ Loader ≤ 1.7 s on fast networks, never more than 2.5 s; skippable; once per session
- ☐ Hero sequence plays once and smoothly at 60 fps on a mid-range phone
- ☐ With reduced motion turned on: no loader, nothing moves, everything readable

Quality

- ☐ Lighthouse (mobile) ≥ 90 for Performance, Accessibility, Best Practices and SEO
- ☐ Keyboard-only run-through; visible focus everywhere; images have alt text
- ☐ Contact form sends; copy email works; all external links open
- ☐ OG preview looks right when the link is pasted into LinkedIn and WhatsApp

The 30-second test

- ☐ A friend scrolls once and can say: your name, your role, the ERP achievement, **your game-dev dream**, and how to contact you

Let's build together!!